Where You Are: The Last Part of Defining Needs, and the Steps That Come After It

All nine steps of the Family Care Roadmap, with step three marked.

With the discharge set and several people waiting on answers, it can seem as if there is no order to any of this. There is one, and you're on step three of nine.

This page lays out the whole road, where you are on it, and what comes after.

Phase 1 · Care Assessment

Understand the person, the family, and the situation.

1. **Discover** Current Situation → Concerns & Challenges → Goals & Priorities
   You finish with: Family Discovery Summary

2. **Assess** Health & Function → Safety & Support → Lifestyle & Preferences
   You finish with: Personal Care Assessment Summary

3. **Define Needs** Needs & Risks → Care Requirements → Priorities & Recommendations
   You finish with: Care Needs Profile and Immediate Action Roadmap

   You are here. You're in the last part of this step, Priorities & Recommendations. It's where what has been learned about your husband's needs becomes an order: which decision is next, what has to be settled before it, and who is doing what. You finish it with the next actions in sequence, a name and a date beside each one where that applies, and a clear route for reviewing every decision that's still open.

Phase 2 · Care Planning

Determine what good care should look like and prepare to put it in place.

4. **Explore Options** Care Setting → Provider/Facility Fit → Selection & Decision
   You finish with: Care Options Comparison and Decision Record

5. **Build the Plan** Health & Personal Care → Daily Life & Quality of Life → Monitoring & Response
   You finish with: Personal Care Proposal, Good Day Plan, and Monitoring Plan

6. **Prepare the Transition** Preparation → Move & Admission → Continuity of Care
   You finish with: Transition Preparation Pack and Confirmed Handoff Log

Phase 3 · Care Management

Coordinate the plan, review what happens, and prepare the family to take the lead.

7. **Coordinate** People & Responsibilities → Communication & Handoffs → Care-Plan Alignment
   You finish with: Care Team Plan and Care-Plan Alignment Record

8. **Monitor** Monitor → Identify & Escalate → Review & Adjust
   You finish with: Care Review Dashboard and Concern/Change Logs

9 **Hand Off** Educate → Empower → Support
You finish with: Family Care Management Playbook and Handoff/Support Plan

What this step produces

An order for the next stretch, in writing: the next care actions in sequence, a name beside each one that someone has agreed to, dates where there are real ones, and for each decision still open, who will review it.

The family's part is the groundwork: the list of decisions, the dates you've been given, what each decision is waiting on, and the offers of help. The order itself is worked out with a professional, on the whole picture of your husband's situation.

His wishes stay at the center of it. AARP's planning guide says every family caregiving plan must center on the wishes of the person receiving the care. [1]

What happens next

This topic is the last of three in Define Needs, and Define Needs is the last step of the first phase, Care Assessment. That phase is about understanding the person, the family and the situation.

The second phase is Care Planning. It opens with step four, Explore Options, which looks at care settings and providers and ends in a decision. Step four starts from what you finish here, which is why nothing on this page touches where your husband's care should happen.

Who is involved, by role

- You and your family: listing the decisions, confirming the dates, and saying plainly what each person can take on.
- Your husband: what he wants, in his own words, and who he wants to see the plan.
- His clinicians and the hospital staff (doctor, nurse, pharmacist, therapist, discharge planner, social worker): the clinical questions, the discharge, and what anything means medically.
- Your care consultant: turns the assessment into a sequence of care decisions and actions, identifies which professionals need to be involved, and helps the family settle first roles so that everything doesn't land on one caregiver.

What this page doesn't promise

How long this step or any later one takes, who will be available, or how things turn out. Each family goes through the steps at its own pace.

Ready for the next step?

You can see where step three sits and what follows it. The care interview is how the whole picture gets onto paper: it walks you through your husband's situation area by area and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

The nine steps are the Family Care Roadmap's own. The line about centering the plan on the person receiving care is from AARP's planning guide.

1. AARP, Prepare to Care: A Planning Guide for Families